

Member Product and Service Guide 2026

Organisation	North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU)
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Document control note: users must confirm status and effective date before relying on a rule. Superseded documents are retained in this synthetic corpus deliberately so that retrieval pipelines can be tested for version awareness.

1. Membership

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies membership in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
1.1	Eligible applicants may join through digital, telephone-assisted or employer-supported routes.
1.2	A minimum opening savings contribution of £5 is normally required before full activation.
1.3	Membership alone does not guarantee lending approval.

Control 1. Eligible applicants may join through digital, telephone-assisted or employer-supported routes. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. A minimum opening savings contribution of £5 is normally required before full activation. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Membership alone does not guarantee lending approval. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

2. Regular Saver

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies regular saver in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
2.1	Regular Saver supports flexible deposits including payroll deduction where available.
2.2	Withdrawals are permitted subject to authentication and any security interest over savings.
2.3	Interest is applied under the published product terms.

Control 1. Regular Saver supports flexible deposits including payroll deduction where available. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Withdrawals are permitted subject to authentication and any security interest over savings. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Interest is applied under the published product terms. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

3. Standard Personal Loan

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies standard personal loan in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
3.1	Standard personal loans are available from £500 to £15,000 subject to policy.
3.2	A member would normally have at least 90 days of active membership.
3.3	Rates and terms depend on the approved product table and risk assessment.

Control 1. Standard personal loans are available from £500 to £15,000 subject to policy. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. A member would normally have at least 90 days of active membership. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Rates and terms depend on the approved product table and risk assessment. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

4. Join and Borrow

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies join and borrow in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
4.1	Join and Borrow is designed for eligible new members who need to borrow before reaching 90 days of membership.
4.2	The maximum principal for a member with less than 90 days' tenure is £2,500.
4.3	Additional affordability and risk controls apply, including a minimum internal risk score of 650 and a 35 percent debt-service guideline.

Control 1. Join and Borrow is designed for eligible new members who need to borrow before reaching 90 days of membership. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. The maximum principal for a member with less than 90 days' tenure is £2,500. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must

be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Additional affordability and risk controls apply, including a minimum internal risk score of 650 and a 35 percent debt-service guideline. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

5. Member Support

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies member support in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
5.1	Members experiencing payment difficulty should contact the credit union as early as possible.
5.2	Support may include adjusted payment arrangements where appropriate.
5.3	Complaints and vulnerability support are available through all core service channels.

Control 1. Members experiencing payment difficulty should contact the credit union as early as possible. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Support may include adjusted payment arrangements where appropriate. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Complaints and vulnerability support are available through all core service channels. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine

deterioration in member outcomes.

6. Service Levels

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies service levels in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
6.1	Straightforward digital membership applications are normally reviewed within one working day.
6.2	Complex lending and manual identity cases may take longer.
6.3	Service levels are targets and do not override control requirements.

Control 1. Straightforward digital membership applications are normally reviewed within one working day. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Complex lending and manual identity cases may take longer. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Service levels are targets and do not override control requirements. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

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